

Ridge

These underwater mountain ranges are created when tectonic plates pull away from each other.

Volcanic island

These mountains rise from the ocean floor as cooling lava hardens into rock.

Magma

Hot magma that rises from deep within Earth creates basalt rock, which makes up most of the oceanic crust.

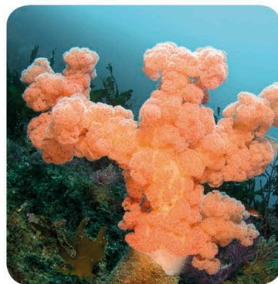
Limited life

Not many animals can survive in the darkest depths of the ocean. Those that do, rely on chemicals instead of light to make their food. Sea life develops around hot springs on the ocean floor, where the water is full of minerals.



Hydrothermal vent

Deep-sea vents release extremely hot water from deep in Earth.



Sea anemones

These creatures cover themselves in sand for protection.



Tube worms

Giant tube worms eat the tiny bacteria that grow near hydrothermal vents.